

Chapter 143-3

"Forget it." Xu Qingzhu climbed off her, picked up her coat from the side, and pushed open the car door to get out.

But just as she was about to leave, Liang Shi grabbed her arm and pulled her back. The car door slammed shut again with a bang.

This time, she was pulled directly into Liang Shi's embrace.

Xu Qingzhu even lost her balance and fell entirely onto Liang Shi, hitting her quite hard.

Liang Shi let out a muffled grunt, but still lowered her head to look at Xu Qingzhu.

Those light brown pupils were like glass marbles—impossibly beautiful.

Xu Qingzhu's eyes were misty with moisture.

"What?" Xu Qingzhu said: "I'm going to work."

"Wait." Liang Shi's hand gripped her wrist tightly, refusing to let go. "Let me think for a moment."

"Then you think first." Xu Qingzhu tried to break free from her grip. "We can talk about it tonight."

"No, it has to be now." Liang Shi stared at her, her fingertips brushing over her lower eyelid. "If I don't explain things clearly to you, you're going to cry again."

Xu Qingzhu was momentarily stunned, then stubbornly turned her face away. "No I won't."

"Delicate little thing."¹ Liang Shi smiled helplessly: "I know you."

"Don't think you understand me so well." Xu Qingzhu said: "You can't even figure things out as a bystander. How could you possibly understand what I'm saying in such a short time?"

Liang Shi pressed her lips together: "What do you mean?"

"Liang Wanwan likes Chen Mian. Did you notice?" Xu Qingzhu said.

Liang Shi: "..."

"No." Liang Shi said, then paused. "Chen Mian is Wanwan's idol. Isn't it normal for her to like Chen Mian?"

"Not that kind of like." Xu Qingzhu said: "It's another kind."

Liang Shi: "..."

"Isn't there only one kind of like?" Liang Shi asked back.

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

"This is why I said I can't explain it to you clearly." Xu Qingzhu said: "You don't need to understand. I'll adjust on my own."

When Xu Qingzhu said the second half of that sentence, there was an indescribable grievance in her voice, but this was already her trying her best to regulate her emotions.

It was still somewhat difficult to control.

If love could be controlled, why would there be so many lovesick fools in this world?

Emotions are inherently complex.

So complex that Xu Qingzhu had spent a long time studying them, yet had only learned the bare basics.

She had also spent a long time troubled by it all, but she always digested it silently on her own.

Telling herself, it's fine—liking someone doesn't mean you need them to like you back.

—Isn't liking someone just being good to them regardless of everything else? Why need any response?

—Liang Shi is already so busy and tired. Don't bother her with these trivial matters.

—Always asking whether she loves me or not seems too clingy. If I'm too clingy, Liang Shi won't like me either.

She had comforted herself with these words countless times, but she was really just too greedy.

She thought she could always keep the promise she made to Liang Shi by the sea—you can kiss me, no need to take responsibility.

Xu Qingzhu had always believed that feelings were her own affair. It was: I like you, you don't need to respond, I'll take responsibility for my own feelings.

Whether or not you like me cannot affect my liking you.

Even if you really don't like me, even if you have many concerns, as long as you're moved in this moment, I can let you irresponsibly enjoy this moment's pleasure.

Because—I love you.

But Liang Shi was too wonderful.

So wonderful that she wanted to possess her completely, wanted her to smile only at her, wanted her to show that indulgent smile only to her, wanted her to be moved only when she was with her.

Xu Qingzhu wanted to be the only one in her world, wanted to be the most special person by her side.

Not simply because she was her wife, so she was gentle to her, so she was good to her.

Liang Shi was good to everyone.

Xu Qingzhu wasn't special.

Just now, Xu Qingzhu had wanted to get an answer. But looking at Liang Shi's troubled expression, Xu Qingzhu felt that the answer wasn't so important anymore.

As long as Liang Shi stayed by her side, that was enough.

She didn't want to see that pained expression on Liang Shi's face.

Xu Qingzhu convinced herself that she could digest this alone.

She wanted to give Liang Shi so much love, wanted to make up for all the love she had never received.

But unknowingly, she had presented Liang Shi with a difficult problem.

Footnotes:

¹ **Delicate little thing** (嬌氣包): Literally "delicate/spoiled bundle," this is an affectionate term used to describe someone who is sensitive, easily upset, or needs to be pampered. It's often used endearingly between lovers to tease someone for being emotionally sensitive or needing extra care.